

POND AND RIVER TURTLES

Found both in the Old and New Worlds, the Geoemydidae are freshwater and terrestrial turtles, ranging in adult shell length from 14 to 50 cm (5½–20 in). They vary in their dietary preferences from being herbivorous to carnivorous. Many exhibit sexual dimorphism, with females being larger than males.



23 cm
9 in

BROWN WOOD TURTLE
Rhynoclemmys annulata

A herbivorous tortoise, this species lives in tropical forests of C. America. It is mainly active in the mornings and after rains.



30 cm
12 in

GOLDEN COIN TURTLE
Cuora trifasciata

This is a carnivorous turtle from S. China. Its name derives from its value in the illegal wildlife market. Its use in traditional medicine threatens its survival.

pronounced
spinal keel



17 cm
6½ in

YELLOW-MARGINED BOX TURTLE
Cuora flavomarginata

An omnivore of China's rice paddies, this species avoids deep water and spends hours basking on land.

yellow
stripes
behind
eyes



13 cm
5 in

ASIAN LEAF TURTLE
Cyclemys dentata

This omnivorous turtle is found in slow-moving waters in S.E. Asia. It defends itself by emitting foul-smelling liquid.



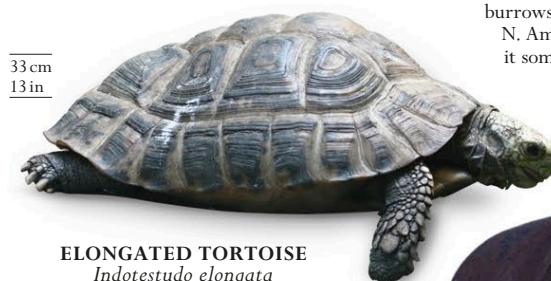
13 cm
5 in

BLACK-BREASTED LEAF TURTLE
Geoemyda spengleri

An inhabitant of wooded mountains in S. China, this turtle eats small invertebrates and fruits. Its carapace is rectangular, keeled, and spiky.

TORTOISES

Found in the Americas, Africa, and southern Eurasia, members of the family Testudinidae can reach great sizes. They have a dome shell into which they can retract their head. Fully terrestrial, tortoises are characterized by elephantine limbs. They lay hard-shelled eggs.



33 cm
13 in

ELONGATED TORTOISE
Indotestudo elongata

Found in tropical S.E. Asia, this tortoise eats fruits and carrion. It hides in moist leaf-litter when the weather is dry.



40 cm
16 in

SERRATED HINGE-BACK TORTOISE
Kinixys erosa

This is an omnivorous species found in swamps in tropical W. Africa. Older tortoises develop hinges in the rear of their carapaces.



70 cm
28 in

RED-FOOTED TORTOISE
Chelonoidis carbonaria

Although known to eat carrion, this tortoise is mainly vegetarian. It is found in a variety of habitats of northeastern S. America.

highly
domed scutes



38 cm
15 in

INDIAN STAR TORTOISE
Geochelone elegans
Found in dry areas of India and Sri Lanka, this herbivorous species mates and breeds in the monsoon season.



30 cm
12 in

DESERT TORTOISE
Gopherus agassizii

This tortoise lives in small burrows in deserts of southwestern N. America. Mainly vegetarian, it sometimes preys on animals.



40 cm
16 in

RADIATED TORTOISE
Astrochelys radiata

Restricted to S. Madagascar, this endangered species eats mainly plants and is active during the early part of the day.